A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE
MBBS, PhD, FRACP
Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist
PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

25 May 2026

Dr Cate Porter
Wingrove Medical Clinic

Dear Dr Porter,

Re: Ms Jane Duffy
DOB: 01/04/1965 Phone: 0400 101 878
Address: 48 Argyle Street, FITZROY, VIC, 3065
Email: jfd_fitz@bigpond.net.au

Summary

- **Stable chronic constipation managed with prucalopride and bisacodyl.**
- **Recent colonoscopy by Dr Guerra demonstrated a redundant colon but was otherwise unremarkable.**
- **Trial of macrogol (Osmolax) to improve stool consistency and reduce stimulant dependence.**
- **No action required by you.**

I had the pleasure of conducting a telehealth review with Jane, who continues to manage her chronic constipation reasonably well.

Jane recently underwent a routine colonoscopy with Dr Guerra. This demonstrated a redundant and long colon, which likely contributes to her symptoms, but was otherwise normal. She has been advised that she does not require a surveillance colonoscopy for another five years.

Clinically, Jane is stable. She remains on 1 mg of prucalopride daily. She supplements this with bisacodyl (Dulcolax) most nights, increasing the dose to two tablets if her bowel movements are infrequent or of a "pellety" consistency. On this regimen, she typically opens her bowels every three days. Her weight remains stable at 58 kg. She continues to experience postprandial abdominal pain specifically related to high-fat dietary triggers.

Impression and Plan Jane previously experienced symptoms suggestive of a small bowel obstruction when attempting to wean her medications. Given her surgical history, I have advised her to continue her current dose of prucalopride. We discussed the transition from stimulant laxatives to osmotic laxatives to achieve a more consistent stool consistency.

I have suggested she trial a macrogol, specifically Osmolax, as the powdered form allows for more granular titration compared to Movicol sachets. The goal is to soften the stool and eventually reduce her requirement for bisacodyl. I have explained that unlike Benefiber, which may be fraught given her history, macrogols work by retaining water in the stool without adding significant bulk.

As Jane is stable and has a clear management plan, I have moved our review interval out to 18 months. I have informed her that you are able to prescribe her prucalopride in the interim, though I am happy to provide scripts via email if required.

All appointments and enquires
Suite 201, 100 Victoria Parade
East Melbourne VIC 3002
Ph: 03 9650 7917
Fax: 03 9650 7910
Pager: 03 9387 1000
Email: office@focusgastro.com.au

Endoscopy locations
Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
Hobson Healthcare Sydenham
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
St Vincent's Private Hospital
59 Victoria Pde, Fitzroy, 3065

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Yours sincerely,

A/Prof Chamara Basnayake
Gastroenterologist

CC: Dr Glen Guerra

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